stable in Tegucigalpa. These prices are about 35.2 and 106.5 percent higher than last year and the five-year average, respectively. Other foods also showed increases.

- Due to stable international prices and the subsidy in Nicaragua, fuel prices in the region remained stable in January with respect to the previous month but remain 16 and 44 percent above last year and the five-year average, respectively. Fertilizer prices remain high but stable in the region compared to December.

the period, below-average rainfall and high temperatures forecast will cause *primera* crops losses and a delay in *postrera* planting, especially for subsistence farmers in the region's Dry Corridor. Nevertheless, national production is expected to be near average thanks to the production of irrigated commercial surplus producers.

- Labor supply is expected to be lower than usual given the reduction by small producers in staple grain production areas and the need to compensate for the impact of the increase in agricultural inputs on the cost of production. At the same time, the increase in the price of labor is expected to continue, but it will not compensate for the low availability of labor.

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Projected Outlook through September 2023

Currently, poor rural households have minimal staple grain reserves from the *postrera* cycle, which occurred at the end of 2022. Harvests were below average because subsistence farmers reduced production areas and the use of fertilizer, and because some areas, especially in Honduras and El Salvador, suffered damage from excess moisture. Between February and March, the last crops from the 2022/2023 *apante* / *postrera tardía* cycle will be harvested in parts of Nicaragua and Honduras. Production consists mainly of beans to be used for commercial purposes, to supplement supplies for the regional market until the *primera* crop is harvested, and to provide income to producer households. This year, despite erratic rainfall, the national production of *apante* / *postrera tardía* crops is expected to be within average ranges, thanks to residual moisture from the 2022 rainy season and timely